

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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Finding reasoning paths :

- 1 . Feelings of sadness , hope lessness , and guilt -> Consider ation of major depressive disorder .
- 2 . Su icidal ide ation , guilt , and energy decline -> Consider ation of major depressive disorder or bipolar disorder .
- 3 . Prol onged depressive symptoms and recent energy decline -> Consider ation of depressive disorder or bipolar disorder .

Reason ing Process :

- 1 . The patient expresses feelings of sadness , hope lessness , and guilt , which are common symptoms of depression . The prolonged nature of these symptoms and their impact on his daily functioning suggest a depressive disorder , potentially major depressive disorder (M DD).
- 2 . The recent energy decline and difficulty concentrating are concerning for a possible depressive episode , as these are common physical and cognitive symptoms of M DD . The persistence of symptoms over two weeks also supports this diagnosis .
- 3 . However , the mention of suicidal ide ation and guilt raises the possibility of a dual diagnosis , such as major depressive disorder with psychotic features or double depression . Double depression is a subtype of major depressive disorder characterized by a long -standing history of depressive symptoms combined with significant impairment , often including psychotic features like halluc inations or del usions .
- 4 . The absence of severe psychotic symptoms (e .g ., halluc inations , del usions) makes schizophrenia or a related psychotic disorder less likely . The focus remains on depressive features , as the presence of suicidal ide ation and guilt align s more closely with M DD with psychotic features rather than a primary psychotic disorder .

Conclusion :

Based on the symptoms and reasoning process , the patient is likely experiencing a depressive disorder , possibly double depression , given the prolonged depressive symptoms and recent energy decline , along with suicidal ide ation and guilt . This align s with the diagnosis of major depressive disorder with psychotic features .

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< answer >

The patient may have symptoms of man ia or psychosis .

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